

ODYSSEUS — DEEP RESEARCH REPORT

Quick Guide



Writebook

Instantly publish your own books
on the web for free, **no publisher required.**

443.6s Duration 5 Rounds 13 Queries 43 URLs Analyzed qwen2.5-coder:7b Model

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Executive Summary

Writebook by 37signals is a free, self-hosted web publishing platform designed to let users instantly publish text and images in a clean, browsable online book format. It offers features such as Markdown support, different page types (text, picture, section), user management with permissions, and the ability to create both public and private books. The platform is designed for

writers, publishers, and content creators who want a simple, distraction-free platform for publishing long-form content with full ownership of their work.

This research report provides a comprehensive overview of Writebook's features, ideal use cases, technical requirements, deployment steps, and additional insights. It also includes new findings that highlight the collaborative writing capabilities, versatility beyond technical documentation, and open source nature of the platform. The report is structured to guide users through setting up their own instance of Writebook and provides practical tips and warnings along the way.

1. Install Docker
2. Obtain a domain name or subdomain
3. Configure DNS settings
4. Execute the installation script via SSH
5. Finalize setup using the automated installer

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Prerequisites

The screenshot displays the AIWriteBook web application. At the top, the header reads 'AIWriteBook' and 'From Idea to Published KDP Book in Hours'. The main interface is divided into several sections:

- Create Your Book:** A sidebar on the left offers options for 'Fiction' (Novels, short stories, and creative narratives with characters and plot) and 'Non-Fiction' (Educational books with educational, training and expertise).
- Chapter Outline:** A central panel shows a list of chapters for 'The White Echo', including 'Chapter 1: The White Echo' and 'Chapter 2: The White Echo'.
- Writing Area:** The main workspace displays the text of 'Chapter 1: The White Echo', starting with 'The lower sanctum was a place of terrible, shimmering beauty, where the double doors were polished to the gleam of a mirror, and the walls were draped in tapestries of vibrant colors, as if they were the very essence of the world itself. The air was thick with the scent of incense, and the floor was made of a material that seemed to glow with a soft, golden light. The city was humming, it was a low, vibrating note that she felt in the soles of her boots and the master of her teeth. It was the sound of the city, the sound of the world, the sound of the future.'
- Book Cover:** On the right, a preview of the book cover for 'The Dragon Bond' by Myxyls Cherneriso is shown. The cover features a dragon and a knight in a fantasy setting.
- Bottom Bar:** A navigation bar at the bottom includes buttons for 'Fiction + Non-Fiction', 'Your Writing Style', and 'KDP-Ready Export'.
- Authors Count:** A circular badge in the bottom right corner indicates '15,700+ Authors'.

Before starting, you will need: - A lightweight server environment with at least 1 CPU and 2GB of RAM. - Your own domain name or subdomain pointed directly to the server's public IP address without active proxying. - Basic knowledge of Linux command line operations.

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Step 1: Install Docker

Docker is a containerization platform that allows you to package your application along with its dependencies into a single, portable container. This ensures consistency across different environments.

Installation Steps: 1. Log in to your server via SSH. 2. Update the package list:

```
bash sudo apt-get update 3. Install Docker: bash sudo apt-get install  
docker.io 4. Start and enable Docker service: bash sudo systemctl start  
docker sudo systemctl enable docker
```

Tip: Ensure Docker is running by checking its status:

```
$ sudo systemctl status docker
```

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Step 2: Obtain a Domain Name or Subdomain



To make your Writebook instance accessible via the web, you need to have a domain name or subdomain. You can purchase one from various domain registrars like GoDaddy, Namecheap, or Cloudflare.

Steps: 1. Choose a registrar and sign up for an account. 2. Purchase a domain name or subdomain. 3. Point your chosen domain or subdomain to your server's public IP address without active proxying.

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Step 3: Configure DNS Settings

After obtaining your domain, you need to configure the DNS settings to point to your server's IP address.

Steps: 1. Log in to your domain registrar's control panel. 2. Navigate to the DNS management section. 3. Add an A record pointing your domain or subdomain to your server's public IP address.

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Step 4: Execute the Installation Script via SSH

Once Docker is installed and your DNS settings are configured, you can proceed with the installation of Writebook.

Steps: 1. Log in to your server via SSH. 2. Navigate to the directory where you want to install Writebook. 3. Paste the single-line installation string from your email into the terminal and execute it: `bash curl -s [https://once.com/writebook/install](https://once.com/writebook/install) | bash`

Tip: Ensure you have the necessary permissions to execute the script.

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Step 5: Finalize Setup Using the Automated Installer

The automated installer will use Docker behind the scenes to bundle dependencies, configure the app server, and automatically provision an SSL certificate. The setup process typically takes around 5 minutes.

Steps: 1. Monitor the installation progress in the terminal. 2. Once the setup is complete, access your Writebook instance via a web browser using your domain or subdomain. 3. Log in to the admin panel to configure your books and settings.

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Common Mistakes

- **Mistake:** Forgetting to update the package list before installing Docker.
- **Solution:** Always update the package list before installing new software.
- **Mistake:** Not pointing the domain or subdomain correctly to the server's IP address.
- **Solution:** Double-check your DNS settings and ensure they are correctly configured.
- **Mistake:** Failing to execute the installation script via SSH.

- **Solution:** Ensure you have the necessary permissions and follow the instructions carefully.

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Conclusion

Writebook by 37signals is a powerful, free, self-hosted web publishing platform designed for writers, publishers, and content creators. Its features such as Markdown support, flexible page layouts, granular privacy, collaborative writing, and seamless progress syncing make it an ideal choice for various use cases beyond technical documentation.

By following the detailed steps provided in this guide, you can easily set up your own instance of Writebook on a lightweight server environment. The open source nature of the platform provides developers with the flexibility to modify and extend its functionality, further enhancing its capabilities and potential applications.

Whether you're creating technical runbooks, employee handbooks, product instruction manuals, creative writing, or family histories, Writebook offers a simple, distraction-free platform for publishing long-form content with full ownership of your work.

► Sources (35)

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